

CLCV-390-01 — New Troy: Reception of the Trojan War

Trinity College · Fall 2026 · Prof. James Staples · Seabury Hall 123

TR 10:50 AM–12:05 PM · staples@trincoll.edu · Office hours W 2–4 PM

*** STAND-IN SYLLABUS — placeholder for pipeline testing, replace with the real one. ***

Course description

A seminar tracing how the fall of Troy has been retold from antiquity to the present — Homer, Virgil, medieval "Troy books," and modern novels and film. Emphasis on how each era remakes the story for its own purposes.

Assessment

Participation and weekly reading responses — 15%

Response paper 1 (4–5 pp.) — due Friday, September 25, 2026 — 15%

Midterm exam — Wednesday, October 21, 2026, in class — 20%

Response paper 2 (4–5 pp.) — due Friday, November 13, 2026 — 15%

Final research paper (12–15 pp.) — due Monday, December 14, 2026 — 20%

Final exam — during the College final period, Thursday, December 17, 2026 — 15%

Weekly reading responses

A short response (~250 words) is due on the course site by 9 AM every Tuesday, weeks 2 through 13. Lowest two are dropped.

Exam coverage

Midterm (Oct 21): Homer's *Iliad*, the epic cycle, Virgil *Aeneid* books 1–2, and Quintus of Smyrna. Format: two short essays and passage identifications.

Final (Dec 17): cumulative, weighted toward material after the midterm — medieval Troy books, Shakespeare's *Troilus and Cressida*, and the modern reception unit.

Policies

Late written work loses one third of a letter grade per day. Extensions are possible with 48 hours' notice. Attendance: more than three unexcused absences lowers the participation grade.